

High Fiber Foods

Supporting Digestive Health Through Diet

Dietary fiber is the part of plant foods that the body cannot digest. Although it is not absorbed, it plays a crucial role in digestive health, blood sugar control, and heart health. Most adults do not meet the recommended daily intake of 25 to 30 grams.

Types of Fiber

Fiber is classified as soluble or insoluble. Soluble fiber, found in oats, beans, apples, and flaxseed, forms a gel in the gut and helps lower blood cholesterol and sugar. Insoluble fiber, found in whole grains, wheat bran, and vegetables, adds bulk to stool and supports regular bowel movements.

How to Increase Fiber Intake

Simple changes can significantly raise daily fiber intake. Choosing whole grains over refined grains, eating fruits and vegetables with the skin, adding legumes to meals, and snacking on nuts and seeds all help. Increase fiber gradually and drink plenty of water.

Suggested Items:

- Whole wheat bread instead of white bread
- Brown rice instead of white rice
- Oats or dalia for breakfast instead of refined cereals
- Beans, lentils, or chickpeas in soups and salads
- Fresh fruit with the skin where edible
- A handful of flaxseed or chia seeds added to curd or smoothies

Reference Table

Food	Fiber (g)	Serving
Lentils (cooked)	15	1 cup
Chia seeds	10	1 ounce
Oats (cooked)	4	1 cup
Apple with skin	4	1 medium
Brown rice (cooked)	3	1 cup

Conclusion

Fiber intake should be increased gradually to allow the digestive system to adjust. Drinking enough water is essential when eating a high-fiber diet.